MOHAMMAD SHERAZ AKBAR

Psychologist | Public Health Professional

Core Competencies:

- ***Strategic Leadership:*** Founder & CEO of TPS Pakistan, leading systemic change in mental health.
- ***Corporate & Social Training:*** Specialized in Leadership Development and Suicide Prevention.
- ***Systems Thinking:*** Designing scalable, sustainable frameworks for community health.
- ***Community Mobilization:*** Expert in organizing and empowering grassroots networks.
- ***Communication:*** Public Speaker and Advocate.

Award Category: Alumni Excellence in Social Impact & Community Service

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Mohammad Sheraz Akbar is a public health strategist and social entrepreneur who has fundamentally redefined mental health advocacy and brought **~845 Million PKR in social value to Pakistan**. As the Founder and CEO of **The Project Suicide (TPS)**, he has moved beyond traditional awareness campaigns to build Pakistan's largest youth-led mental health safety net. Combining his background as a Psychologist and Public Health Professional (Health Services Academy), Sheraz specializes in "Upstream Prevention." He engineered the *"Human Infrastructure"* model a decentralized network of 650+ student gatekeepers who intercept suicide crises before they occur. His work is globally recognized, validated by the **World Federation of United Nations Associations (WFUNA), SpareBank1smn Norway, United Nations Association of Pakistan (UNAP)**, featured at the **UN General Assembly**, and documented by national and international media.

PROFESSIONAL JOURNEY: FROM CAMPUS TO GLOBAL STAGE

Sheraz's journey represents the ideal trajectory of a COMSATS alumnus: applying academic rigor to solve real-world societal problems.

- **Public Health Strategist:** Currently serving as a CEO of TPS and working on his final research as a Public Health Professional at the **Health Services Academy (HSA)** under the Ministry of National Health Services, bridging the gap between national policy and grassroots action.
- **The "Modig" Distinction:** Winner of the ***"Under the Starry Sky"*** program by WFUNA and SpareBank 1 SMN (Norway). He was the only international participant selected for the documentary "MODIG" (The Brave), filmed in Norway to inspire global youth action.
- **Global Expedition:** Represented Pakistan on the **Statsraad Lehmkuhl** ship expedition, collaborating with change-makers from 27 nations on sustainability.
- **Thought Leadership:** Delivered Pakistan's first-ever **TEDx talk** on "Adventure Psychology & Suicide Prevention," introducing a novel approach to resilience building.

THE INNOVATION: THE PROJECT SUICIDE (TPS)

Sheraz founded TPS to solve the "Treatment Gap", the reality that while help exists, stigma prevents youth from reaching it.

- **The "Human Infrastructure":** A decentralized network of **650+ Student Ambassadors** across **65+ Universities** in **30 Cities**. These are not just volunteers; they are trained frontline responders.
- **Cultural Shift:** Under his leadership, 65 universities that previously refused to discuss suicide now actively partner with TPS to host seminars, marking a historic shift in academia.
- **UN Chartered Partner:** TPS serves as the Chartered Partner of the **United Nations Association of Pakistan (UNAP x TPS)**, integrating the UN SDGs directly into mental health frameworks.

THE "BRAIN GAIN" ALLIANCE (GLOBAL COLLABORATORS)

Sheraz serves as the Chairperson of the **Mental Health Alliance Pakistan**, a coalition he designed to reverse the "Brain Drain" by bringing global expertise *into* Pakistan. He has secured high-level collaborations to "donate" corporate-grade training to Pakistani youth:

Global Strategic Partners: WFUNA, SpareBank1SMN (Norway), UNA Norway, United Nations Association of Pakistan, Catalyst 2030 (Global). PMI Switzerland, ODE Systems (Germany), Gilgal Dabihn (UK), Health Services Academy (MoNHSRC), British Asian Trust, Milkar Campaign Pakistan and many more. . .

THE "BILLION-RUPEE" IMPACT (SOCIAL & ECONOMIC VALUE)

Unlike traditional NGOs, TPS uses WHO frameworks to track "Hard Data." In the last cycle alone, Sheraz's leadership delivered an estimated **~845 Million PKR** in social and economic value to Pakistan.

A. Operational Reach

- **40,000+ People Reached:** Direct, face-to-face engagement sessions across 3 years.
- **1,000+ Gatekeepers Trained:** Students certified in Psychological First Aid (PFA) and Crisis Management.
- **30 Cities Activated:** Breaking the urban-rural divide by reaching remote areas.

B. Mortality Reduction (Lives Saved)

- **Metric: 40 Verified Lives Saved** (Intercepted at crisis point, avg. age 22).
- **Health Impact:** Averted **1,800 Years of Life Lost (YLLs)** from Pakistan's disease burden.

- **Economic Value: ~800 Million PKR** ($2.88 Million USD). *Calculation:* Preserving the lifetime human capital and workforce productivity of 40 young Pakistanis.

C. Morbidity Reduction (Health Restored)

- **Metric: 300 Professional Referrals** successfully connected to psychologists.
- **Health Impact:** Recovered **52.5 Years of Healthy Life (YLDs)**.
- **Economic ROI: ~14.4 Million PKR.** *Calculation:* Based on the WHO's 4:1 Return on Investment benchmark for mental health treatment (restored productivity and education retention).

MEDIA & GLOBAL FOOTPRINT

Sheraz's work has been documented internationally, validating the program's credibility beyond borders:

- **International Media:** *MN24 Norway* (Featured as an Adventure Psychologist), *The Truth International*.
- **Documentary:** *MODIG: The Brave* (SpareBank 1 SMN, Norway) .
- **National Media:** *The News International, Geo News, ABN News*.
- **Global Feature:** Highlighted in the **Catalyst Now Impact Report 2024-25** launched at the **UN General Assembly**.

Conclusion: Mohammad Sheraz Akbar has not just founded an organization; he has built a national asset. By turning a volunteer network into a high-yield public health engine, he has proven that youth-led leadership is the most effective solution for Pakistan's future. He is a distinguished alumnus who brings honor to the institution.

Note: *Evidence and reference documents will be shared on demand.*

Represented CUI in Norway (WFUNA)

Receiving Awards/Certification at WFUNA